

GROWRIDER · CALCULATION

GrowRider sizing calculations

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	First issue for TRL 3 (fit, reach, steering, mass, rack, braking, service, cost, strength screen, drive and trip time)

GrowRider sizing calculations

On paper, GrowRider meets five of its twelve requirements, misses one and has four at risk; two cannot be verified at TRL 3. The fit works: the two-stage seat post gives 400 to 670 mm of saddle height with 100 mm of insertion at every sliding joint, which covers the 1.10 to 1.65 m range under both fitting rules used here, and standover is 455 mm against 470 mm. The miss is mass: about 15.3 kg against 13 kg (R5). Braking (R7), service tools and time (R9), cost (R11) and frame life (R12) are at risk. Every number in this note is printed by `docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`; the tag in brackets, for example [A2], is the line of that script's output that carries it.

Safety: These calculations concern a bicycle ridden by children on roads shared with motor traffic. They are first-principles estimates for a paper proof of concept and are not a substitute for the brake, frame, fork, handlebar and seat post tests of ISO 8098 or ISO 4210. Nothing may be ridden on the strength of this note. See GRR-PRC-001, Safety.

■ Scope and method

The note checks every requirement in GRR-REQ-001 v0.3 against the design in GRR-PRC-001 v0.3 and the parametric model `cad/src/model.py`. The script imports the model's `PARAMS`, so the frame, wheel, seat post, stem and rack dimensions used here are the ones in the STEP files and in drawing GRR-DWG-001. Run it from the repo root with `python docs/04-calcs/sizing.py`.

■ Assumptions

Table 1. Main assumptions.

Area	Assumption	Basis
Riders	1.10 m and 19 kg (about age 6); 1.38 m and 32 kg (about age 10); 1.65 m and 60 kg (about age 14, with a margin)	Global growth references; 60 kg from GRR-REQ-001. To check against children in the target region
Fit	Inseam 0.45 x height. Rule A: BB to saddle top 0.88 x inseam (adult rule used at TRL 2). Rule B: saddle top to pedal at the bottom of the stroke 1.09 x inseam, so BB to saddle = 1.09 x inseam minus the 140 mm crank	Common fitting rules of thumb; rule B accounts for the crank length, which matters for small riders
Reach	Horizontal saddle-to-grip reach about 0.2 x height	Placeholder from GRR-REQ-001
Mass center	Rider 0.18 x height above the saddle top and a quarter of the way from saddle to grips; bike at 45 % of the wheelbase ahead of the rear axle and 0.40 m high	Upright seated posture; engineering judgment
Grip	Tire to ground friction 0.7 dry, 0.4 loose gravel	Handbook ranges
Coaster brake	Hub brake torque 2.5 x the sprocket torque (2 to 3 typical, to confirm from hub data); a seated rider back-pedals with 0.5 x body weight	Assumed; no hub datasheet yet
Rim brake	Total pad force 5 x lever force; pad friction 0.5 dry, 0.3 on a wet alloy rim, 0.1 on a wet steel rim; braking radius 200 mm; lever force 40, 70 and 150 N for the three riders	Typical side-pull and short-reach lever; wet steel rims are known to brake poorly
Steel	Hi-tensile tube, yield 250 MPa (conservative); 60 MPa at 1 g as a fatigue screen for brazed, welded or clamped joints; 2.5 g peak bump factor; 70 % of rider weight on the saddle	Screening values, not a fatigue analysis
Masses	Tubes from the model's lengths and wall sizes at 7,850 kg/m ³ ; bought parts from typical catalog values (Table 3)	To confirm by weighing parts
Riding	Rolling coefficient 0.02 (solid tire on gravel), CdA 0.35 m ² , air 1.2 kg/m ³	Handbook ranges

■ A. Fit (R1, R2)

Table 2. Saddle height needed across the fit range [A1].

Rider	Inseam	Rule A (0.88 x inseam)	Rule B (1.09 x inseam minus crank)
1.10 m	495 mm	436 mm	400 mm
1.38 m	621 mm	546 mm	537 mm
1.65 m	742 mm	653 mm	669 mm

- **Range.** The two stages give 400 to 670 mm from BB center to saddle top, a 270 mm range [A2]. The 28.6 mm sleeve slides 130 mm in the 31.8 mm seat tube and the 25.4 mm post slides 140 mm in the sleeve. This covers 400 to 669 mm, the widest need under either rule, and so also the 436 to 654 mm target of R2.
- **Insertion.** At full extension the sleeve, the post and the quill stem each keep 100 mm inside the part below [A3]. Fully lowered, the sleeve reaches 230 mm and the post 220 mm below the seat tube top, inside the 240 mm of clear bore above the BB shell [A4].
- **Standover.** The loop tube top is 455 mm above the ground 100 mm ahead of its joint with the seat tube, where a rider stands to mount [A5]. A 1.10 m rider's 495 mm inseam clears it by 40 mm. R1 is met, with a thin margin.

- **Saddle above ground.** 636 mm at the smallest setting to 890 mm at the largest [A6]. The smallest rider cannot reach the ground from the saddle and stops by sliding forward, as on any bicycle.
- **Crank length.** The 140 mm crank is 0.28 of the smallest rider's inseam and 0.19 of the largest [A7]. Small riders will pedal with a large knee bend at the top of the stroke; this is the reason for the later 127 mm option (GRR-DDR-001, D5).

Rule A, used at TRL 2, sets the smallest saddle 36 mm too high for a 1.10 m rider on 140 mm cranks. The design now covers both rules; R2's target range is not changed (see REVIEW, proposed).

■ B. Reach and handlebar height (R3)

- **Bar height.** 120 mm of quill travel along the 70° steering axis raises the bar 113 mm; the grips also move back 41 mm as they rise [B1].
- **Reach.** At the smallest setting the saddle-to-grip reach is 241 to 331 mm across the two stem head positions (0 or 60 mm) and the ± 15 mm saddle rail; the placeholder need is 220 mm. At the largest setting it is 292 to 382 mm against 330 mm [B2]. Over the fit range the reach adjusts by 141 mm [B3]. R3 is met.
- **Bar above the saddle.** At the smallest setting the grips are 128 mm above the saddle top; at the largest they are 13 mm below it [B4]. The small rider sits very upright. The cause is the 180 mm head tube needed to give the quill 100 mm of insertion with 120 mm of travel; a flat bar instead of the 25 mm rise would lower it slightly.

■ C. Wheel size and steering (R4)

- One wheel size, 20 in (ISO 406), for every rider; tire outside diameter 500 mm and rolling circumference 1.57 m [C1]. R4 is met.
- Trail is 59 mm with a 70° head angle and 30 mm fork offset [C2], in the usual range for small wheels.
- The fork crown clears the tire by 26 mm; with a 16 mm tire-to-fender gap, the fender clears the crown by 6 mm [C3]. Mud clearance is tight in the rainy season.
- Toe overlap: none for the smallest rider; about 19 mm for the largest when the bar is turned [C4]. This is normal on small-wheeled bikes but should be shown to riders.
- Pedal clearance is 109 mm; a pedal strikes at about 32° of lean [C5].

■ D. Mass (R5)

The frame, from the model's tube lengths and walls, is about 2.77 kg [D1].

Table 3. Mass estimate [D2].

#	Part	kg	#	Part	kg
1	Frame	2.77	11	Chain	0.30
2	Fork, long steerer	0.95	12	Front brake, lever, cable	0.35
3	Sleeve and seat post	0.62	13	Rack	0.70
4	Saddle	0.45	14	Fenders (plastic)	0.40
5	Quill stem and head	0.53	15	Chainguard	0.25
6	Handlebar and grips	0.65	16	Kickstand	0.30
7	Front wheel (alloy rim)	0.95	17	Reflectors and bell	0.15
8	Rear wheel, coaster hub	2.00	18	Bottom bracket and headset	0.45
9	Solid tires (2)	2.20	19	Hardware	0.15
10	Crankset and pedals	1.15	Total		15.3

The complete bike is about 15.3 kg, 2.3 kg over the 13 kg target and 81 % of a 19 kg six-year-old's weight [D3]. **R5 is not met.** Options [D4]: pneumatic tires with thorn-resistant tubes and liners (0.50 kg), chromoly main tubes with 0.9 mm walls (0.96 kg), an aluminium rack (0.35 kg), an alloy rear rim (0.20 kg) and an alloy handlebar (0.20 kg). Taken together they reach about 13.1 kg [D5], still just over the target, and the tire option reverses decision D4. The TRL 2 estimate of about 1 kg saved by pneumatic tires was too high; this note finds about 0.5 kg.

■ E. Mass center and rack (R6)

- With rider, the combined mass center is 342 mm ahead of the rear axle and 640 mm high for the 1.10 m rider, 306 and 814 mm for the 1.38 m rider, and 271 and 1,027 mm for the 1.65 m rider. The front wheel carries 40, 36 and 31 % of the weight [E1].
- With 10 kg on the rack, the front wheel share falls to 33 % for the smallest rider and 29 % for the largest [E2]. A heavier load would make steering light and unsafe for a small child; this supports the 10 kg rating.
- The 300 x 120 mm platform meets the size limit. Rail bending at 10 kg and 2.5 g is 35 MPa in 12 x 1 mm tube against 250 MPa yield [E3]. R6 is met by design; the static load test is later work.

■ F. Braking (R7)

Table 4. Braking on a dry, level road [F1] to [F4].

Rider	Rear (coaster) grip limit	Back-pedal force for 0.2 g, available	Coaster, achieved	Front lever force for 0.2 g, assumed	Front, achieved	Both
1.10 m	0.28 g	85 N, 93 N	0.22 g	34 N, 40 N	0.24 g	0.46 g
1.38 m	0.27 g	118 N, 157 N	0.27 g	46 N, 70 N	0.30 g	0.57 g
1.65 m	0.26 g	187 N, 294 N	0.26 g	74 N, 150 N	0.41 g	0.57 g

- On paper each brake alone reaches 0.2 g and both together at least 0.46 g, so the R7 targets are met. For the smallest rider the margins are small: 9 % on back-pedal force and 18 % on lever force. **R7 is at risk** until the coaster hub's brake ratio and children's lever and back-pedal forces are known.
- On loose gravel the coaster alone is limited to 0.19 g by rear-wheel grip for every rider [F1], so the front brake is needed.
- Pitch-over limits the largest rider to 0.57 g with the front brake [F1].
- **Wet rims.** A wet steel rim needs 168 N at the lever for 0.2 g with the smallest rider; a child can manage about 0.05 g. A wet alloy rim needs 56 N and gives about 0.14 g [F3]. An alloy front rim is proposed (REVIEW).
- Stopping from 15 km/h takes 4.4 m at 0.2 g and 2.5 m at 0.35 g, plus 4.2 m in a 1 s reaction [F5].

■ G. Puncture resistance (R8)

Solid or airless tires (decision D4) cannot puncture, so the first half of R8 is met by selection. Tire life of 2,000 km depends on the compound and needs supplier data. R8 is not verifiable at TRL 3.

■ H. Service and fit change (R9)

- A fit change by task analysis takes about 10 minutes: two seat post collars, the stem expander, the stem head position, a brake cable and lever check, and an insertion-mark check with a test ride [H1]. This is at the 10 minute limit.
- Fit adjustments need only a 13 mm spanner and a screwdriver; wheels and pedals need 15 mm. The 1 in threaded headset needs a 32 mm spanner and a cup-and-cone bottom bracket needs a locking spanner [H2]. Roadster mechanics carry these, but R9 names only 13 and 15 mm spanners. **R9 is at risk.**
- The front brake housing must carry slack for 120 mm of stem travel, or every fit change also needs a cable adjustment.

■ I. Parts commonality (R10)

Chain, coaster hub internals, 1 in headset, 25.4 mm seat post, 22.2 mm handlebar and 9/16 in pedal threads were chosen to match adult roadster parts. The fork needs a longer steerer than a stock 20 in fork, and the sleeve and long quill are made parts. Whether the rest are stocked in the target region needs a partner's parts list. R10 is not verifiable at TRL 3.

■ J. Cost (R11)

The 20-line BOM totals \$243 for the bike (lines 1 to 19) and \$255 with the \$12 helmet, against the \$250 budget [J1]. The bike is within budget with a \$7 margin; with the helmet it is \$5 over, and the helmet's funding is still open (GRR-DDR-001, O1). The \$120 production target at volume (decided, D6) needs an estimate from a regional assembler. **R11 is at risk.**

■ K. Strength screen (R12)

A screen, not a fatigue analysis, for the largest rider (60 kg) at the largest setting.

Table 5. Section stresses [K1] to [K4].

Section	Load case	Stress	Screen
Seat post at the sleeve top	1 g saddle load, 97 mm lever	54 MPa (136 MPa at 2.5 g)	Passes
Sleeve at the seat tube top	1 g, 148 mm lever	74 MPa (186 MPa at 2.5 g)	Above 60 MPa
Seat tube at its clamp	1 g, 148 mm lever	59 MPa (148 MPa at 2.5 g)	At the limit
Quill at the steerer top	300 N vertical and 200 N pull at the grips, full extension	45 N m, 77 MPa	Above 60 MPa
Steerer at the crown	0.41 g front braking, 591 N normal and 300 N brake force	78 N m, 117 MPa	Above 60 MPa
Fork blades at the crown	2.5 g bump	54 MPa (22 MPa at 1 g)	Passes

Three of six sections are above the 60 MPa screen; none reaches the 250 MPa yield at the peak load [K5]. All three are the price of adjustability: long levers at full extension of the sleeve and quill, and a standard 1 in steerer under an adult-scale rider. Chromoly or thicker-walled sleeve, quill and steerer, or a shorter maximum extension, would bring them under the screen. Whether greased steel sleeves seize in dust and rain over ten years cannot be assessed by calculation. **R12 is at risk.**

■ L. Drive, power and trip time

- 32/18 gives 2.79 m per crank turn, so 11 km/h is 66 rpm [L1]. The chain is 86 links [L2].
- Power on the level at 11 km/h is 27, 34 and 51 W for the three riders; a 5 % climb at 7 km/h takes 47, 65 and 102 W. On that climb the smallest rider pushes a mean pedal force of 42 % of body weight [L3], so steep hills will be walked.
- A 5 km trip takes 60 to 75 min walking and 25 to 30 min cycling [L4]. At the midpoints this returns about 79 min per day, about 249 h per 190-day school year [L5].

■ M. Applicable standard

The maximum saddle height is 890 mm above the ground [M1]. ISO 8098:2023 covers bicycles for young children with a maximum saddle height of more than 435 mm and less than 635 mm; ISO 4210-2:2023 covers young adult bicycles from 635 mm to less than 750 mm and city and trekking bicycles from 635 mm up. Classified by its maximum saddle height, GrowRider falls under ISO 4210-2 as a city and trekking bicycle, even though its smallest setting (636 mm) serves riders of ISO 8098 size. The scope limits were checked on the ISO catalog pages for [ISO 8098:2023](#) and [ISO 4210-2:2023](#); the test loads have not been read, as the standards were not purchased.

■ Results against requirements

Table 6. Requirement status (GRR-REQ-001 v0.3), not met and at risk first.

ID	Requirement	Value	Target	Status
R5	Mass	15.3 kg	13 kg or less	Not met
R7	Two independent brakes	Coaster 0.22 g, front 0.24 g, both 0.46 g (smallest rider, dry); wet steel rim about 0.05 g	0.2 g each, 0.35 g together, dry	At risk
R9	Basic tools, 10 min fit change	10 min; fit needs 13 mm and a screwdriver; headset and BB need 32 mm and lockring spanners	13 and 15 mm spanners, screwdriver; 10 min	At risk
R11	Cost	\$243 bike, \$255 with helmet; production not estimated	\$250 prototype; \$120 at volume	At risk
R12	Lasts across siblings	3 of 6 sections above the 60 MPa screen; seizing not assessable	10 years, 3 riders, 60 kg plus 10 kg	At risk
R8	Puncture resistance	Solid tires, no punctures; life unknown	No punctures; 2,000 km	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R10	Parts commonality	Chosen to match; no regional list	All wear parts but tires and rims	Not verifiable at TRL 3
R1	Fit the riders	1.10 to 1.65 m; standover 455 mm	1.10 to 1.65 m; 470 mm or less	Met
R2	Saddle height	400 to 670 mm; 100 mm insertion	436 to 654 mm; 100 mm insertion	Met
R3	Reach and bar height	Bar 113 mm; reach 141 mm	100 mm or more each	Met
R4	One wheel size	20 in (ISO 406)	One size	Met
R6	Rack	300 x 120 mm; 35 MPa at 2.5 g	10 kg, marked; 300 x 140 mm or less	Met

Totals: 5 met, 1 not met, 4 at risk, 2 not verifiable at TRL 3.

■ Checks against earlier figures

The TRL 2 figures in GRR-PRC-001 v0.2 were checked against the script and the documents were corrected where they differed:

- Saddle range: 436 to 654 mm (rule A only) became 400 to 670 mm; the rise and setback over the range are now 254 mm and 92 mm.
- Reach adjustment: about 124 mm became 141 mm.
- Standover: about 460 mm became 455 mm.
- Mass: about 15.5 kg became 15.3 kg; the saving from pneumatic tires is about 0.5 kg, not 1 kg.
- Front brake pitch-over: 0.76 g became 0.57 to 0.81 g depending on the rider; rear coaster limits (0.27 g dry, 0.19 g gravel) are confirmed.
- Power on a 5 % climb: about 60 W became 65 W for the 1.38 m rider; the level figure (about 35 W) is confirmed at 34 W.
- Commute time and gear figures are confirmed.